

(Buxus vahliae)

Vahl's boxwood

Family (Buxaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

Is a critically endangered, evergreen shrub or small tree growing 1–5 meters tall, endemic to Puerto Rico and potentially St. Croix. It is characterized by shiny, dark green opposite leaves, distinctive two-grooved twigs, and small, horn-edged capsules that release black seeds.



Location/Habitat

Is an endangered, slow-growing evergreen shrub found in highly restricted, shaded, limestone ravine habitats in northern/northwestern Puerto Rico and St. Croix, U.S. Virgin Islands. It is largely confined to mature subtropical moist forests, often clinging to steep slopes.